# SEO Changelog: Where Is Crab Island?

URL: https://crabislandtikitoursdestin.com/about-crab-island/where-is-crab-island/ | WP page ID 787 (block content) | Last modified July 27, 2026 | Audit date: October 28, 2026 | Page 8 of the site queue

Method: content, headings, links, images and SEO meta were pulled from WordPress through the site connector. The live URL could not be loaded from the audit environment. Template issues A to G from the What Is Crab Island changelog (broken charter links, $900, plain-text phone, footer self-link, FAQ markup, shared infographic, author line) also apply here and are not repeated in detail.

## 1. Summary

| Item | Current state |
|---|---|
| Role | Answers "where is crab island" and related location queries ("how far is crab island from...", "crab island coordinates", "crab island map"). |
| SEO title | Where Is Crab Island? Location & Distance From Destin (53 characters, good) |
| Meta description | 150 characters, no price, good. Keep. |
| H1 | Where Is Crab Island? (good) |
| Body copy | About 1,700 words, useful distance table, airports, parking and arrival advice. |
| Missing for this query | No map. A "where is" page without a map or directions link is the most obvious gap. |
| Internal links | 2 body links: FareHarbor and a **broken** /contact-us/ link. No link to the Private Charter page at all. |

## 2. Critical fixes

| # | Issue | Fix |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | P1 Broken contact link | "contact page" links to `/contact-us/`. The real page is `/contact-crab-island-tiki-tours-destin/`. Fix the link and add a 301 from /contact-us/ (other guides may use it too; include it in the site-wide search and replace). |
| 2 | P1 Add a map | Embed a Google Map (or a static map image with alt text) showing Destin Harbor, the departure address, the Marler Bridge and Crab Island. Add a "Get directions to 530 Harbor Blvd Suite #13" link that opens Google Maps. |
| 3 | P1 Check compass directions and distances | Have the captain confirm these before Google or an AI answer repeats them: "Stand at HarborWalk Village and look northeast", "Look left toward the East Pass", HarborWalk "on the north side", and Okaloosa Island "about 6 miles" by water. Okaloosa Island's east end sits right across the East Pass from Destin, so 6 miles looks high unless it means a specific marina. A wrong direction on a "where is" page undercuts the rest of it. |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 4 | P1 No link to the charter page | The closing CTA links only to FareHarbor and Contact. Add "private Crab Island charter" linking to /charters/private-crab-island-charter-destin/. |
| 5 | P2 Template items | "$900" in the CTA, three plain-text phone numbers, footer self-link, FAQ not marked up (template B, C, D, E). |

## 3. SEO title and meta description

| Field | Current | New |
|---|---|---|
| SEO title | Where Is Crab Island? Location & Distance From Destin | Keep. Optional test: **Where Is Crab Island? Map, Location and Distance From Destin** (60 characters) once the map is added. |
| Meta description | Where is Crab Island? Just north of the Marler Bridge in Destin, FL, about half a mile from Destin Harbor. Coordinates, distances, and how to reach it. | Keep. |
| Focus keyword | Primary: **where is crab island**. Secondary: crab island map, crab island coordinates, how far is crab island from destin, crab island location. | |

## 4. Heading structure

### Current

```
H1  Where Is Crab Island?
H2  Key Takeaways
H2  The Exact Location
H2  Distance From Common Starting Points
H2  Why Departing From Destin Harbor Matters
H2  Getting to Destin by Car and Air
H2  Landmarks You Pass on the Way Out
H2  Coming From Elsewhere on the Emerald Coast
H2  Can You See Crab Island From Shore?
H2  Parking and Check-In Near the Departure Point
H2  Frequently Asked Questions
  H3  x5
H2  Book a Charter Minutes From the Sandbar
H2  More Crab Island Questions Answered
```

### New

```
H1  Where Is Crab Island?
H2  Key Takeaways
H2  Crab Island Map                                (new)
H2  The Exact Location
H2  Distance From Common Starting Points
H2  Why Departing From Destin Harbor Matters
H2  Getting to Destin
```

```
  H3  Driving In on Highway 98 and I-10          (merges "Coming From Elsewhere")
  H3  Flying In: VPS, ECP and PNS
H2  Landmarks You Pass on the Way Out
H2  Can You See Crab Island From Shore?
H2  Parking and Check-In at Destin Harbor
H2  Crab Island Location FAQs
  H3  x5 existing + 1 new
H2  Book a Charter Minutes From the Sandbar
H2  More Crab Island Questions Answered
```

"Getting to Destin by Car and Air" and "Coming From Elsewhere on the Emerald Coast" both describe Highway 98 drive times. Combining them under one H2 with two H3s removes the repetition.

## 5. Content rewrites (paste-ready)

### H2: Crab Island Map (new, directly after Key Takeaways)

> *[Embedded Google Map centered on 30.394, -86.512, zoomed to show Destin Harbor and the Marler Bridge]*
>
> Crab Island is the shallow, light-green area just north of the Marler Bridge. Our boat leaves from 530 Harbor Blvd Suite #13 on Destin Harbor, about half a mile away. Get directions to the dock.

### H2: Getting to Destin (merged)

> **H3: Driving In on Highway 98 and I-10**
> Highway 98 runs along the Emerald Coast through Destin. From the north, take I-10 and head south through Crestview, Niceville or Freeport. From Miramar Beach and 30A, Destin is 20 to 40 minutes west on 98. From Fort Walton Beach and Okaloosa Island, it's 20 to 30 minutes east across the Brooks Bridge. Panama City Beach is about an hour each way, so most visitors from there book a 6 or 8 hour charter. Traffic on 98 through Destin backs up between noon and 6 p.m. in summer, so leave extra time.
>
> **H3: Flying In: VPS, ECP and PNS**
> The closest airport is Destin-Fort Walton Beach (VPS). Northwest Florida Beaches International (ECP) is about an hour east, and Pensacola International (PNS) about an hour and a half west. Private aircraft use Destin Executive Airport (DTS).

### New FAQ

> **Is there a Crab Island address?** No. The sandbar has no street address because it sits in the water. Use the coordinates 30.394, -86.512 for marine navigation, or 530 Harbor Blvd Suite #13, Destin, FL to reach our dock.

### Wording fixes

- "It is one of the shortest runs to a major attraction anywhere on the Emerald Coast." Unprovable. Change to: "It's one of the shortest boat rides to any attraction in Destin."

- "Dolphins work that pass constantly" to "Dolphins are often seen in the pass."
- "in a harbor full of similarly named operators" is a strong, specific tip. Keep it, and make sure the Google Business Profile name and address exactly match this page.

## 6. Internal linking

| Anchor text | Target | Placement |
|---|---|---|
| contact page | /contact-crab-island-tiki-tours-destin/ | Fix broken link |
| private Crab Island charter | /charters/private-crab-island-charter-destin/ | Why Departing From Destin Harbor + CTA |
| sunset loop | /charters/private-sunset-cruise-in-destin-fl/ | Why Departing From Destin Harbor |
| a shallow shoal | /about-crab-island/what-is-crab-island-destin/ | The Exact Location |
| pale turquoise of the shoal | /about-crab-island/how-deep-is-crab-island/ | Landmarks |
| Swimming out is not an option | /about-crab-island/how-to-get-to-crab-island/ | Can You See It From Shore |
| fill by late morning on weekends | /about-crab-island/best-time-to-visit-crab-island/ | Parking |
| things to do in Destin | /things-to-do-in-destin-besides-crab-island/ | Coming From Elsewhere |
| Crab Island guide | /about-crab-island/ | Key Takeaways footer |

## 7. Images

| File | Current alt | Action |
|---|---|---|
| thumbnail-7.webp (400×400) | Where is Crab Island | Replace with a wide photo from the Marler Bridge or an aerial of the sandbar. Alt: "Crab Island sandbar north of the Marler Bridge in Destin, Florida". Set as featured image. |
| Crab-Island-Tiki-Boat-Rental.png | Crab Island Tiki Boat Rental Infographic | Swap for a labeled map graphic on this page (harbor, bridge, sandbar, East Pass). That image is far more relevant here than the shared infographic. |

## 8. Technical

| # | Item | Action |
|---|---|---|

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | P1 Place schema | Add `about` referencing the Crab Island TouristAttraction (geo 30.394, -86.512) and a LocalBusiness reference with the departure address. FAQPage via Rank Math block. |
| 2 | P2 Map embed performance | Lazy-load the Google Maps iframe ( `loading="lazy"` ) or use a static image linked to Google Maps so it doesn't slow the page. |
| 3 | P2 Redirect | 301 /contact-us/ to the Contact page. |
| 4 | P3 Breadcrumbs | Home > About Crab Island > Where Is Crab Island. |

## 9. Tracking

| Event | Setup |
|---|---|
| directions_click | Fire on the "Get directions" link. It's a strong signal of a booked guest getting ready to arrive, and useful for measuring the map's value. |
| map_interaction | Optional: if using a static map image linking to Google Maps, count clicks on it. |
| phone_click / book_now_click | `guide_name=where_is` . |
| Search Console | Watch "crab island map" and "how far is crab island from [place]" queries. If those grow, add more rows to the distance table. |

## 10. Changelog

| # | Area | Change | Priority | Status |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Links | Fix /contact-us/ link and add 301 | P1 | To do |
| 2 | Content | Add Crab Island Map section with embed and directions link | P1 | To do |
| 3 | Content | Captain verifies compass directions and the Okaloosa Island distance | P1 | To do |
| 4 | Links | Add private charter link; 8 more contextual links | P1 | To do |
| 5 | Template | $900, tel: links, footer self-link, FAQ block | P1 | To do |
| 6 | Headings | Merge car/air and Emerald Coast sections under one H2 with 2 H3s; add Map H2 | P2 | To do |
| 7 | Content | New "Is there a Crab Island address?" FAQ; soften 2 claims | P2 | To do |
| 8 | Images | Wide lead photo, labeled map graphic, featured image | P2 | To do |
| 9 | Technical | Place and FAQPage schema, lazy map, breadcrumbs | P2 | To do |
| 10 | Tracking | directions_click event | P2 | To do |